

Legal Ease

UI Design and Development Documentation

Version: 1.0 **Date:** September 30, 2026 **Frontend stack:** React + TypeScript (Vite), matching the earlier setup guide.

Assumption: Legal Ease is a web app that helps people understand, organize and act on legal documents in plain language. You haven't described the exact features, so the screens below are a sensible default. Send me your real feature list and I'll align this document to it.

1. Purpose and goals

- Make legal content approachable: plain language, clear next steps, no jargon walls.
- Build trust: a calm, professional look that signals privacy and reliability.
- Be usable by everyone: WCAG 2.2 AA accessibility from day one.
- Work on any device: mobile-first, responsive up to wide desktop.

2. Users

Persona	Needs	UI implication
Everyday client	Understand a contract or notice quickly	Plain-language summaries, big clear actions
Small business owner	Store, compare and track documents	Search, folders, status labels, deadlines
Legal professional	Review fast, annotate, share	Dense views, keyboard shortcuts, audit trail

3. Design principles

- **Clarity first:** one primary action per screen.
- **Progressive disclosure:** show the summary, reveal detail on demand.
- **Reassure:** confirm saves, show privacy cues, explain errors kindly.
- **Consistency:** reuse components, never restyle one-off.
- **Inclusive:** keyboard, screen reader and low-vision friendly.

4. Information architecture

```
Public
  Landing -> Sign up / Log in -> Forgot password
App (authenticated)
  Dashboard
  Documents
    List -> Upload -> Document detail
      Tabs: Summary | Full text | Key dates | Notes | Sharing
  Templates
  Deadlines / Calendar
  Search
  Settings
    Profile | Security | Notifications | Billing | Privacy
Help
  FAQ | Contact | Legal disclaimer
```

5. Key screens

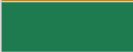
Screen	Main elements	Primary action
Landing	Hero, value points, trust badges, footer disclaimer	Get started
Sign up / Log in	Email, password, show/hide, SSO buttons	Create account / Log in
Dashboard	Recent documents, upcoming deadlines, quick upload card	Upload document
Upload	Drag-and-drop zone, file type hint, progress bar	Upload
Document list	Search, filters, sortable table (cards on mobile)	Open document
Document detail	Plain-language summary, flagged clauses, key dates, side notes	Ask / Share
Deadlines	Calendar and list toggle, reminders	Add reminder
Settings	Grouped forms, danger zone for delete	Save changes

6. Wireframe: document detail (desktop)

```
+-----+
| Logo  [ Search documents..... ]      (Avatar) |
+-----+
| Sidebar | Lease Agreement - Oak St          [Share] [More] | | | | |
|         | Status: Active   Uploaded: Sep 12          |
| Home    | [Summary] [Full text] [Key dates] [Notes] [Sharing]|
| Docs    | +-----+ +-----+ |
| Templ.  | | Plain-language summary          | | Key dates    | |
| Dates   | | ...                          | | Rent due 1st | |
| Settings| | Flagged clauses (3) [View]    | | Ends Aug 31 | |
|         | +-----+ +-----+ |
+-----+
Mobile: sidebar becomes bottom tab bar; side panel stacks below.
```

7. Design system

7.1 Color tokens

Swatch	Token	Hex	Use
	--color-primary	#1F3A5F	Buttons, links, headings
	--color-primary-hover	#162B47	Hover / pressed
	--color-accent	#B8892B	Highlights, badges
	--color-success	#1E7B4F	Confirmations
	--color-warning	#B36B00	Cautions, flagged clauses
	--color-danger	#B3261E	Errors, delete
	--color-bg	#F7F8FA	App background
	--color-surface	#FFFFFF	Cards, panels
	--color-text	#1B1F24	Body text

Swatch	Token	Hex	Use
	--color-border	#D5DAE1	Dividers, inputs

All text and background pairs must meet contrast 4.5:1 (3:1 for large text and UI borders).

7.2 Typography

Style	Font	Size / weight
Display / H1	Inter (fallback: system-ui)	32px / 700
H2	Inter	24px / 600
H3	Inter	20px / 600
Body	Inter	16px / 400, line-height 1.6
Small / caption	Inter	14px / 400
Legal text	Source Serif 4 (fallback: Georgia)	16px / 400, line-height 1.7

7.3 Spacing, radius, elevation

- Spacing scale (4px base): 4, 8, 12, 16, 24, 32, 48, 64.
- Radius: 6px inputs and buttons, 12px cards, 999px pills.
- Shadows: sm for cards, md for menus and modals. Prefer borders over heavy shadows.
- Breakpoints: 480 (mobile), 768 (tablet), 1024 (desktop), 1280 (wide). Max content width 1200px.

7.4 Core components

Component	Variants and states
Button	Primary, secondary, ghost, danger. States: default, hover, focus, disabled, loading
Input / Textarea	Default, focus, error (with message), disabled. Always a visible label
Select, Checkbox, Radio, Switch	Keyboard operable, clear checked state
Card	Static, clickable, selected
Table / List	Sortable headers, empty state, responsive card fallback
Tabs	Underline style, arrow-key navigation
Modal / Drawer	Focus trap, Esc to close, returns focus on close
Toast / Alert	Info, success, warning, error. Polite live region
Badge	Status: Draft, Active, Expired, Needs review
FileDropzone	Idle, drag-over, uploading, error, done
Skeleton, Spinner	Loading placeholders for lists and detail
Breadcrumb, Pagination	Used in Documents and Search

8. UX rules

- Every list and page has designed **loading**, **empty** and **error** states.
- Errors say what happened and how to fix it. No raw codes shown to users.
- Destructive actions require confirmation and offer undo where possible.
- Forms validate on blur and on submit; keep the user's input on error.
- Show a short disclaimer where content could be mistaken for legal advice: Legal Ease provides information, not legal advice.

9. Accessibility checklist (WCAG 2.2 AA)

- Semantic HTML: landmarks, one H1 per page, logical heading order.
- All interactions work by keyboard; visible 2px focus ring.
- Labels for every input; errors linked with aria-describedby.
- Alt text for meaningful images; decorative images hidden.
- Touch targets at least 44 x 44px.
- Respect prefers-reduced-motion and support browser zoom to 200%.
- Do not rely on color alone; pair with icon or text.
- Test with a screen reader (VoiceOver, NVDA) and axe DevTools.

10. Frontend architecture

```
frontend/src/  
  main.tsx  
  App.tsx  
  routes/      # route definitions, guards  
  pages/       # Dashboard, Documents, DocumentDetail, Settings...  
  components/
```

```

    ui/                # Button, Input, Modal, Tabs (design system)
    layout/            # AppShell, Sidebar, Topbar
    documents/          # DocumentCard, DocumentTable, FileDropzone
    features/           # auth, documents, deadlines (logic + hooks)
    api/                # API client, endpoint functions
    hooks/
    styles/             # tokens.css, global.css
    utils/
    types/
    tests/

```

Concern	Choice
Framework	React 18 + TypeScript + Vite
Routing	React Router
Server state	TanStack Query (caching, retries, loading flags)
Forms	React Hook Form + Zod validation
Styling	CSS variables for tokens + Tailwind CSS or CSS Modules
Accessible primitives	Radix UI (dialog, tabs, dropdown)
Icons	lucide-react
Docs / sandbox	Storybook for components
Quality	ESLint, Prettier, TypeScript strict mode
Testing	Vitest + React Testing Library, Playwright for end-to-end

11. Design tokens in code

```

/* styles/tokens.css */
:root {
  --color-primary: #1F3A5F;
  --color-primary-hover: #162B47;
  --color-accent: #B8892B;
  --color-success: #1E7B4F;
  --color-warning: #B36B00;
  --color-danger: #B3261E;
  --color-bg: #F7F8FA;
  --color-surface: #FFFFFF;
  --color-text: #1B1F24;
  --color-border: #D5DAE1;
  --radius-sm: 6px; --radius-md: 12px;
  --space-1: 4px; --space-2: 8px; --space-3: 12px;
  --space-4: 16px; --space-6: 24px; --space-8: 32px;
  --font-sans: Inter, system-ui, sans-serif;
  --font-legal: "Source Serif 4", Georgia, serif;
}

```

12. Example component

```
// components/ui/Button.tsx
import type { ButtonHTMLAttributes } from "react";

type Props = ButtonHTMLAttributes<HTMLButtonElement> & {
  variant?: "primary" | "secondary" | "danger";
  loading?: boolean;
};

export function Button({ variant = "primary", loading, children,
  disabled, ...rest }: Props) {
  return (
    <button
      className={`btn btn-${variant}`}
      disabled={disabled || loading}
      aria-busy={loading}
      {...rest}
    >
      {loading ? "Please wait..." : children}
    </button>
  );
}
```

13. API integration

- Base URL from **VITE_API_URL** in .env (backend runs on port 8000 in development).
- One typed API client; components never call fetch directly.
- Auth token kept in an httpOnly cookie, not localStorage.
- Map API errors to friendly messages in one place.
- Uploads: validate type and size on the client, then stream with progress.

14. Security and privacy in the UI

- Never log or display sensitive document text in the console or error messages.
- Auto sign-out after inactivity; clear sensitive state on logout.
- Sanitize any rendered user or document content (avoid dangerouslySetInnerHTML).
- Show clear consent and data-handling notes at upload.
- Use fake sample data in development; never real client documents.

15. Development workflow

Phase	Output
1. Discover	Feature list, personas, user flows
2. Wireframe	Low-fidelity screens for key flows
3. Design system	Tokens and core components in Storybook
4. High-fidelity	Polished designs, responsive states
5. Build	Pages from components, connect API
6. Test	Unit, accessibility, cross-browser, mobile devices
7. Review and launch	Usability test with 5 users, fix, release

```
cd frontend
npm run dev      # start dev server
npm run lint     # ESLint
npm run test     # Vitest
npm run storybook # component workshop
npm run build    # production build
```

16. Definition of done for a screen

- Matches design tokens and reuses shared components.
- Responsive at 375, 768 and 1280px widths.
- Loading, empty and error states implemented.
- Passes axe checks and keyboard-only walkthrough.
- Unit tests for logic; one end-to-end test for the main flow.
- Reviewed by a teammate.